Assistive Technology (Beyond Screen Readers)

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What is it for?

Assistive technology includes tools that help people with disabilities use a computer.

Devices like magnifiers, switches, and voice control help people zoom in, or navigate without a mouse or keyboard.

Poor design, like tiny text or mouse-only buttons, can completely block these users.

How to support it

Support these tools by making website layouts compatible with them.

- Prioritise keyboard navigation: test with only ‘Tab’, ‘Shift + Tab’, ‘Enter’, ‘Space’, arrow keys and ‘Escape’
- Ensure layouts don't break when text is zoomed, and use clear, written labels instead of just icons
- Make sure any information shown on hover is also available by tabbing to it

Useful Links

WebAIM - Introduction to Assistive Technology